

# ProgramSelf v0.1

## Structural Architecture, Format Architecture, and Initial Aesthetic Direction

ProgramSelf is a project of **ULiUA** and **Consentful Cybernetics**.

It begins as a simple, portable, interoperable framework for creating **Path Receipts**: human-readable, machine-parseable semantic artifacts that help a person cast vague future-anxiety into invariant, attractor, consent, intervention, feedback, and update.

ProgramSelf is not an app.

It is not a productivity platform.

It is not a behavioral capture system.

It is a static public site for a living format.

The website exists to explain, generate, validate, and share Path Receipts.

The receipt is the primary object.

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## 1. Core Positioning

### 1.1 One-sentence positioning

**ProgramSelf is a portable format for invariant-grounded self-orientation, consented path facilitation, and local AI context.**

### 1.2 Human-facing positioning

ProgramSelf helps people make their own path easier without betraying themselves.

It is for people who can feel the attractor before they can explain the plan.

It helps translate vague future-anxiety into a clear semantic artifact that can be read by the self, shared with witnesses, interpreted by tools, and eventually used by local assistant AI.

## 1.3 Technical positioning

ProgramSelf defines a simple receipt format for encoding:

- future-noise,
- invariants,
- attractors,
- consent boundaries,
- non-consent boundaries,
- interventions,
- grounding,
- feedback signals,
- update rules,
- visibility,
- lineage.

The artifact is designed to be:

- human-readable,
- machine-parseable,
- portable,
- interoperable,
- local-first,
- tool-agnostic,
- AI-readable,
- forkable,
- inspectable.

## 1.4 Philosophical positioning

ProgramSelf begins where ordinary goal-setting fails.

Most goals are artifacts. They are written down, checked off, ignored, or weaponized by the ego.

But a person's life is often organized around attractors: living directions, recurring pulls, unresolved values, fields of meaning, and invariants that want to be preserved across transformation.

ProgramSelf uses artifacts to help people remain oriented toward attractors.

The Path Receipt is not the path.

The Path Receipt helps recover the path when the signal gets noisy.

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## 2. Foundational Distinctions

### 2.1 Artifact versus attractor

An **artifact** is discrete, addressable, stable, captured, and witnessed.

An **attractor** is continuous, field-like, evolving, emergent, and inferred.

Examples:

| Artifact         | Attractor                 |
|------------------|---------------------------|
| A checklist      | A life of embodied health |
| A calendar block | Creative sovereignty      |
| A meal plan      | Household care            |
| A receipt file   | Self-trust                |
| A note to self   | A direction of becoming   |

ProgramSelf treats artifacts as orientation tools, not final truths.

### 2.2 Goal versus invariant

A goal says what someone wants to achieve.

An invariant says what must remain preserved across attempts, failures, adaptations, and changes in plan.

Example:

Goal:

Write every morning.

Invariant:

Preserve contact with the creative field without sacrificing embodied health or relational dignity.

The goal may change.

The invariant stabilizes the field.

## 2.3 Anxiety as future-signal

ProgramSelf treats some anxiety as uncast future-signal.

Not all anxiety is meaningful. Not all anxiety should be theorized. But often, vague future-anxiety contains an unarticulated invariant.

ProgramSelf begins with the question:

What invariant is this anxiety trying to protect?

The receipt does not eliminate uncertainty.

It gives uncertainty a structure to move through.

## 2.4 Consent versus force

There is a difference between forcing yourself and authorizing assistance.

Force says:

You are failing. Try harder.

Consent says:

This matters. Make the path easier in ways I have agreed to.

ProgramSelf does not use shame as fuel.

It asks:

- What kind of assistance is welcome?
- What kind of assistance would betray the path?
- What interventions are allowed?
- What forms of optimization are forbidden?
- What feedback should change the model?

The ego becomes steward rather than tyrant.

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## 3. Product Boundary

### 3.1 ProgramSelf is not an app

ProgramSelf should not become a destination platform.

No account is required.

No dashboard is required.

No cloud storage is required.

No behavioral exhaust is required.

No surveillance is required.

No private profile is required.

The primary object is a portable semantic artifact.

### 3.2 ProgramSelf is a format

ProgramSelf should function more like:

- Markdown,
- RSS,
- JSON Feed,
- schema.org,
- frontmatter,
- a field note format,
- a local-first semantic convention.

The website introduces the format and helps people create receipts.

But the receipt must remain useful outside the website.

### 3.3 Architectural invariant

**A Path Receipt must remain useful when copied into a plain text file.**

If the artifact requires a database, login, server, wallet, plugin, API, or app to remain meaningful, the system has drifted.

## 3.4 No lock-in

Anyone should be able to:

- write a Path Receipt by hand,
  - generate one from the website,
  - edit it in a text editor,
  - store it locally,
  - publish it publicly,
  - share it with a friend,
  - give it to a local AI,
  - fork the format,
  - build another generator,
  - create a community invariant set.
- 

## 4. The Path Receipt

### 4.1 Definition

A **Path Receipt** is a standardized, human-readable, machine-parseable receipt for consented path facilitation.

It records:

This is what I am trying to preserve.  
This is the attractor I am orienting toward.  
This is the help I consent to.  
This is the help I refuse.  
This is the intervention being attempted.  
This is why it is grounded.  
This is how feedback should update the path.

### 4.2 Minimal fields

A v0.1 Path Receipt includes:

1. **Future-noise**

The vague anxiety, pressure, or unresolved signal being cast.

2. **Invariant**

The good being preserved or strengthened.

3. **Attractor**

The direction the person wants life to bend toward.

**4. Consent**

Forms of assistance that are welcome.

**5. Non-consent**

Forms of assistance that would betray the path.

**6. Intervention**

One small thing that will make the path easier.

**7. Grounding**

Why the intervention is believed to serve the invariant.

**8. Feedback**

Signals that indicate help, harm, pressure, avoidance, connection, or misalignment.

**9. Update**

What should change next time.

**10. Visibility**

Whether the receipt is self-only, trusted, community, or public.

**11. Lineage**

When, where, and under what project/frame the receipt was created.

## 4.3 Minimal prompt template

Path Receipt

Future-noise:

What anxiety, pressure, or unresolved future-signal am I carrying?

Invariant:

What good am I trying to preserve or strengthen?

Attractor:

What direction do I want my life to bend toward?

Consent:

What kind of assistance is welcome?

Non-consent:

What kind of assistance would betray the path?

Intervention:

What is one small thing that would make the path easier?

Grounding:

Why do I believe this serves the invariant?

Feedback:

How will I know whether it helped, harmed, or needs adjustment?

Update:

What should change next time?

Visibility:

Who, if anyone, may witness this?

Lineage:

Created with ProgramSelf, a project of ULiUA and Consentful Cybernetics.

## 4.4 Example receipt

```
---
type: PathReceipt
version: "0.1"
title: Creative sovereignty without burnout
visibility: self
projects:
  - ULiUA
  - Consentful Cybernetics
created: 2026-06-06
invariants:
  - creative sovereignty
  - embodied health
  - relational dignity
consent:
  allowed:
    - gentle structure
    - protected time
    - environment design
    - weekly reflection
    - reminders of the attractor
  forbidden:
    - shame
    - panic productivity
    - public comparison
    - output obsession
    - treating rest as failure
---

# Path Receipt: Creative sovereignty without burnout
```



## ## Future-noise

I feel anxious that I am wasting my creative life.

## ## Invariant

Protect creative sovereignty, embodied health, and relational dignity.

## ## Attractor

A life where meaningful work emerges regularly without sacrificing my body or relationships.

## ## Consent

I consent to gentle structure, protected time, environment design, weekly reflection, and reminders of the attractor.

## ## Non-consent

I do not consent to shame, panic productivity, public comparison, output obsession, or treating rest as failure.

## ## Intervention

Create one 90-minute protected making block this week with no output requirement.

## ## Grounding

The invariant is not "publish more." The invariant is maintaining contact with the creative field while preserving health and dignity.

## ## Feedback

After the block, record whether I feel more connected, more pressured, more avoidant, or more alive.

## ## Update

If pressure rises, reduce the block to 30 minutes. If connection rises, repeat next week.

## ## Visibility

Self.

```
## Lineage
```

Created with ProgramSelf, a project of ULiUA and Consentful Cybernetics.

## 5. Format Architecture

### 5.1 Preferred canonical artifact

The preferred canonical artifact is a Markdown file with YAML frontmatter:

```
creative-sovereignty.path.md
```

This allows one file to serve both humans and machines.

The body is readable prose.

The frontmatter provides structured metadata.

### 5.2 Optional companion JSON

A generated receipt may also be exported as:

```
creative-sovereignty.path.json
```

This is useful for local AI, validators, import/export tools, and future interoperability.

### 5.3 Filename pattern

Suggested simple format:

```
[slug].path.md  
[slug].path.json
```

Examples:

```
creative-sovereignty.path.md  
vegetables-without-shame.path.md
```

```
relationship-repair.path.md
local-contribution-without-burnout.path.md
```

For contexts using the Artifact Spine Protocol, generated files may also support:

```
YYYYMMDD__PROGRAMSELF__RECEIPT__PERSONAL__SELF__[SLUG].md
```

Example:

```
20260606__PROGRAMSELF__RECEIPT__PERSONAL__SELF__CREATIVE-SOVEREIGNTY.md
```

## 5.4 JSON shape

A v0.1 JSON object may look like:

```
{
  "type": "PathReceipt",
  "version": "0.1",
  "title": "Creative sovereignty without burnout",
  "futureNoise": "I feel anxious that I am wasting my creative life.",
  "invariant": {
    "statement": "Protect creative sovereignty, embodied health, and relational
dignity.",
    "protects": [
      "creative sovereignty",
      "embodied health",
      "relational dignity"
    ]
  },
  "attractor": {
    "statement": "A life where meaningful work emerges regularly without
sacrificing my body or relationships."
  },
  "consent": {
    "allowed": [
      "gentle structure",
      "protected time",
      "environment design",
      "weekly reflection",
      "reminders of the attractor"
    ],
    "forbidden": [
      "shame",

```

```

    "panic productivity",
    "public comparison",
    "output obsession",
    "treating rest as failure"
  ]
},
"intervention": {
  "description": "Create one 90-minute protected making block this week with
no output requirement."
},
"grounding": {
  "rationale": "The invariant is not publishing more. The invariant is
maintaining contact with the creative field while preserving health and
dignity.",
  "evidence": [],
  "assumptions": []
},
"feedback": {
  "signals": [
    "more connected",
    "more pressured",
    "more avoidant",
    "more alive"
  ],
  "reflectionPrompt": "After the block, record whether I feel more connected,
more pressured, more avoidant, or more alive."
},
"updateRule": {
  "ifHelpful": "If connection rises, repeat next week.",
  "ifHarmful": "If pressure rises, reduce the block to 30 minutes."
},
"visibility": "self",
"lineage": {
  "createdAt": "2026-06-06",
  "source": "ProgramSelf",
  "project": [
    "ULiUA",
    "Consentful Cybernetics"
  ]
}
}

```

## 5.5 Schema principle

The schema should remain small enough to understand at a glance.

It can evolve, but v0.1 should resist excessive complexity.

The central structure is:

```
future-noise → invariant → attractor → consent → intervention → feedback →  
update
```

## 5.6 Machine readability

The format should support future use by:

- local assistant AI,
- static site generators,
- personal knowledge management tools,
- text editors,
- Markdown systems,
- JSON validators,
- community model libraries,
- version control,
- local search,
- MCP-style local servers,
- interoperability layers.

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# 6. Local AI Architecture

## 6.1 Central claim

A local assistant should not have to guess the soul from behavioral exhaust.

Path Receipts provide consented semantic context.

They tell an assistant what matters, what kind of help is welcome, what shortcuts are forbidden, and how feedback should update future assistance.

## 6.2 What local AI can learn from a receipt

A Path Receipt tells an assistant:

- what invariant matters,
- what attractor is active,
- what assistance is authorized,
- what assistance is forbidden,
- what intervention is being attempted,
- what grounding is being used,

- what feedback signals matter,
- what update rules should apply.

## 6.3 Proper assistant behavior

Given a receipt, a local assistant should ask:

Which active Path Receipt applies here?

Not:

How do I maximize engagement?

Not:

What can I infer from behavioral exhaust?

Not:

How do I move the person without them noticing?

The assistant should operate inside declared semantic boundaries.

## 6.4 Example assistant use

If the active receipt says:

Invariant:

Preserve embodied health and self-respect.

Consent:

Meal suggestions and grocery defaults are welcome.

Non-consent:

No calorie obsession, body-image pressure, or shame.

Intervention:

Make vegetable-forward dinners easier.

Update:

If reminders annoy me twice, reduce reminder frequency.

Then a local assistant may say:

You have rice, lentils, carrots, and yogurt. Want the low-friction dinner path?

It should not say:

You failed your health goals again.

## 6.5 Local-first principle

The receipt should be usable from a local folder:

```
~/ProgramSelf/receipts/
```

A local assistant may eventually read:

```
~/ProgramSelf/receipts/*.path.md  
~/ProgramSelf/receipts/*.path.json
```

Future possible operations:

```
get_active_receipts()  
get_receipt_by_invariant()  
create_path_receipt()  
update_receipt_feedback()  
archive_receipt()  
suggest_intervention_within_consent()
```

These are future possibilities, not v0.1 requirements.

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# 7. Website Architecture

## 7.1 Recommended stack

ProgramSelf v0.1 should use:

- **Astro** for the static site framework,
- **Tailwind CSS** for styling,
- **TypeScript** for structured generation logic,
- optional **Svelte island** or plain TypeScript for the receipt generator,
- optional **Zod** later for validation,
- no required backend,
- no database,
- no accounts.

## 7.2 Why Astro

Astro fits because ProgramSelf is:

- content-first,
- static-first,
- fast,
- simple,
- portable,
- component-friendly,
- progressively enhanceable.

The site is primarily explanatory and document-like.

Only the receipt generator needs interactivity.

## 7.3 Why Tailwind

Tailwind fits because the aesthetic needs:

- precise spacing,
- restrained typography,
- reusable card styles,
- light/dark potential,
- fast iteration,
- minimal custom CSS,
- easy static deployment.

## 7.4 Initial site map

```
/
  Home / manifesto / orientation

/path-receipt
  Path Receipt Format v0.1

/create
  Create a Path Receipt

/examples
  Example receipts

/invariant-set
  Emerging invariant set and reusable patterns

/local-ai
```



Using Path Receipts with local assistant AI

/about

Project lineage: ULiUA + Consentful Cybernetics

## 7.5 Recommended file structure

```
programself/  
  src/  
    components/  
      Hero.astro  
      ReceiptCard.astro  
      ReceiptField.astro  
      PathReceiptForm.svelte  
      Footer.astro  
      SiteNav.astro  
    content/  
      examples/  
        invariant-set/  
          pages/  
            layouts/  
              Baselayout.astro  
            lib/  
              receiptSchema.ts  
              receiptMarkdown.ts  
              receiptJson.ts  
              slugs.ts  
            pages/  
              index.astro  
              path-receipt.astro  
              create.astro  
              examples.astro  
              invariant-set.astro  
              local-ai.astro  
              about.astro  
            public/  
              favicon.svg  
              og-image.png  
            astro.config.mjs  
            package.json  
            tsconfig.json
```

## 7.6 v0.1 features

The v0.1 site should include:

- static landing page,
- receipt format explanation,
- pure client-side receipt generator,
- live preview,
- copy Markdown,
- copy JSON,
- download `.path.md`,
- download `.path.json`,
- example receipts,
- initial invariant set page,
- local AI explanation page,
- project lineage page.

## 7.7 Explicit exclusions

v0.1 should not include:

- accounts,
- dashboard,
- cloud sync,
- database,
- login,
- analytics-heavy behavior tracking,
- gamification,
- social feed,
- public profiles,
- push notifications,
- proprietary storage,
- hidden recommendation logic.

## 7.8 Generator behavior

The generator should be simple.

It asks for each field, then produces the receipt.

It should not store the data.

It should not send the data to a server.

It should not require an API.

It should help the user create a portable artifact.

## 7.9 AI-assisted creation

AI assistance may be added later, but should not be required.

The first AI-assisted feature can simply provide a prompt template:

```
I want to create a ProgramSelf Path Receipt.

Help me cast the following future-noise into:
future-noise, invariant, attractor, consent, non-consent, intervention,
grounding, feedback, and update.

Do not shame me.
Do not optimize for productivity alone.
Preserve sovereignty, reversibility, and consent.

Future-noise:
[PASTE HERE]
```

Later, a server-side or local AI tool may generate candidate fields, but the human remains the authority.

AI proposes.

The participant edits, accepts, rejects, or revises.

---

## 8. Invariant Set Architecture

### 8.1 What is an invariant set?

As Path Receipts accumulate, patterns emerge.

Common invariants, attractors, consent boundaries, harmful interventions, helpful interventions, and update rules can be collected into reusable semantic scaffolds.

These become an **invariant set**.

Not because an authority declares them final.

Because they survive repeated contact with lived experience.

## 8.2 Initial invariant set categories

The `/invariant-set` page can begin with reusable lists.

### Common invariants

```
creative sovereignty
embodied health
relational dignity
self-trust
continuity
repairability
attention integrity
emotional regulation
local resilience
non-extraction
reversibility
agency
household care
meaningful contribution
```

### Common attractors

```
a life where meaningful work emerges regularly
a household where health is easier than neglect
a relationship where repair is more available than defense
a community where contribution does not require burnout
an AI assistant that serves declared meaning rather than inferred compulsion
a body that feels trusted rather than managed
a creative practice that remains alive under pressure
```

### Common consent permissions

```
gentle reminders
environment design
default setup
reflection prompts
social witnessing
local AI assistance
friction reduction
scheduled review
meal suggestions
```

protected time  
accountability by invitation

### Common non-consents

shame  
guilt  
panic productivity  
public comparison  
body-image pressure  
doom  
identity coercion  
hidden optimization  
unbounded tracking  
irreversible escalation  
surveillance  
scorekeeping  
moralizing

### Common update rules

If pressure rises, reduce scope.  
If connection rises, repeat.  
If avoidance rises, lower activation energy.  
If shame appears, remove the framing.  
If resentment appears, check consent.  
If the artifact becomes rigid, return to the attractor.  
If the intervention feels coercive, pause and recast consent.  
If the goal becomes hollow, recover the invariant.

## 8.3 Recursive insight

A framework of invariants, if it succeeds in capturing the essence of its parts, becomes an invariant set.

ProgramSelf does not need to define all invariants upfront.

It needs a format that helps real invariants become visible over time.

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## 9. Aesthetic Direction

### 9.1 Core aesthetic

ProgramSelf should feel like:

a quiet operating manual for the soul, written by someone who understands computers.

The aesthetic is:

warm technical minimalism.

It should be:

- calm,
- precise,
- readable,
- portable,
- slightly strange,
- deeply non-coercive,
- technically credible,
- emotionally safe.

It should not feel like:

- productivity SaaS,
- wellness fluff,
- AI hype,
- clinical self-tracking,
- hustle culture,
- surveillance software,
- crypto dashboard,
- mystical fog.

### 9.2 Vibe anchors

Useful tonal references:

- Unix manual page meets sacred notebook.
- Markdown spec meets field journal.
- Local-first software docs meets ego-stewardship ritual.
- Plaintext constitution meets gentle personal operating system.
- Early web clarity with modern typography and softness.
- A future local-first operating system discovered as a text file.

## 9.3 Emotional target

A visitor should feel:

- “I can breathe.”
- “This respects me.”
- “This is not trying to capture me.”
- “This is precise enough to matter.”
- “This is strange in the way I am strange.”
- “I could use this today.”
- “My local AI would understand me better if I gave it this.”

## 9.4 Visual design rule

Every visual choice should preserve:

- sovereignty,
- legibility,
- calm,
- portability.

No urgency manipulation.

No fake scarcity.

No dark patterns.

No dopamine carnival.

No “AI magic” spectacle.

No needless animation.

No lock-in aesthetics.

## 9.5 Color palette

Initial light palette:

|              |         |
|--------------|---------|
| Paper :      | #F7F3EA |
| Ink:         | #1E1D1A |
| Muted ink:   | #68635A |
| Line:        | #DDD4C3 |
| Deep violet: | #3C2F58 |
| Sage:        | #6F8068 |

|          |         |
|----------|---------|
| Clay:    | #A65F46 |
| Code bg: | #EFE8DA |

Optional future dark palette:

|            |         |
|------------|---------|
| Void:      | #11100E |
| Surface:   | #1A1815 |
| Ink:       | #F2EBDD |
| Muted ink: | #B8AD9A |
| Line:      | #373027 |
| Gold/sand: | #C7A96B |
| Violet:    | #9D8BFF |

The site should likely begin light-first.

## 9.6 Typography

Recommended type direction:

- Main prose: **Source Serif 4**
- UI labels/navigation: **Inter** or similar humanist sans
- Code/schema/receipts: **IBM Plex Mono** or **JetBrains Mono**

Preferred combination:

|                 |                |
|-----------------|----------------|
| Body:           | Source Serif 4 |
| UI labels:      | Inter          |
| Code/artifacts: | IBM Plex Mono  |

This gives:

- literary warmth,
- technical precision,
- strong readability,
- artifact/spec credibility.

## 9.7 Layout

The layout should be text-forward.

Suggested constraints:



Prose max width:  
680-760px

Wide content max width:  
920-1040px

Spacing:  
generous, book-like, calm

Navigation:  
minimal top nav

Hero:  
typographic, not illustration-heavy

Avoid marketing-page overload.

The site should feel like a living spec, not a funnel.

## 9.8 Navigation

Initial top nav:

ProgramSelf  
Path Receipt  
Create  
Examples  
Invariant Set  
Local AI

Optional project lineage link:

ULiUA / Consentful Cybernetics

## 9.9 Hero direction

The homepage hero should be mostly typographic.

Example:

ProgramSelf

Make the path easier  
without betraying yourself.

A portable format for invariant-grounded self-orientation,  
consented path facilitation, and local AI context.

Below the hero, show a Path Receipt preview card.

The receipt card is the primary visual object.

## 9.10 Receipt card visual language

The Path Receipt should look like:

- an index card,
- a field note,
- a protocol card,
- a spell receipt,
- a machine-readable prayer,
- a tiny constitution.

Design qualities:

- rounded rectangle, but not overly app-like,
- thin border,
- warm paper surface,
- monospace labels,
- serif content,
- clear fields,
- minimal decoration,
- inspectable structure.

Example visual hierarchy:

PATH RECEIPT / v0.1

Creative sovereignty without burnout

Invariant

Protect creative sovereignty, embodied health, and relational dignity.

Attractor

A life where meaningful work emerges regularly...

Consent

Allowed: gentle structure, protected time  
Forbidden: shame, panic productivity

The receipt card should recur across the site.

## 9.11 Symbolic motifs

Glyphs may appear, but sparingly.

Possible mappings:

consent 𐄂  
boundary 𐄃  
loop 𐄄  
witness 𐄅  
breach 𐄆

Public-facing pages should not depend on glyph literacy.

Glyphs can appear as subtle marginal marks or secondary labels.

They should enrich, not obscure.

## 9.12 Diagrams

Use sparse line diagrams.

Avoid glossy AI-brain imagery.

Useful diagrams:

future-noise → invariant → attractor → consent → intervention → feedback →  
update

Path Receipt folder → Local assistant → Authorized help

artifact: written receipt  
attractor: living direction

Thin lines.

Soft arrows.

Monospace labels.

No 3D.

No neural network cliché.

## 9.13 Texture

A slight paper texture or subtle gradient is acceptable.

It should be barely visible.

The surface should feel warm, not decorative.

Avoid clutter.

## 9.14 Interaction aesthetic

The create page should feel like casting, not form-filling.

Use language such as:

- Begin with one signal.
- Name what must be preserved.
- Choose the help you would welcome.
- Mark what would betray the path.
- Preview receipt.
- Copy Markdown.
- Download `.path.md`.
- Copy JSON.

Avoid language such as:

- Submit.
- Optimize.
- Unlock.
- Crush your goals.
- Complete your profile.
- Become your best self.
- 10x your productivity.

## 9.15 UI copy tone

The tone should be calm, direct, precise, and non-coercive.

Examples:

Do not solve your whole life.  
Begin with one signal.  
This can be revised later.  
The receipt is not the path.  
If this becomes shame, reduce scope.  
If the artifact becomes rigid, return to the attractor.

## 10. Homepage Content Architecture

### 10.1 Suggested homepage sections

1. Hero
2. The problem
3. Artifact versus attractor
4. What is a Path Receipt?
5. Why consent matters
6. For local AI
7. Example receipt
8. A project of ULiUA + Consentful Cybernetics
9. Begin

### 10.2 Hero copy draft

ProgramSelf

Make the path easier  
without betraying yourself.

A portable format for invariant-grounded self-orientation,  
consented path facilitation, and local AI context.

### 10.3 Problem copy draft

Most goals are too floppy to survive contact with life.

"I want to be healthier."  
"I want to be more creative."  
"I want to stop wasting time."

These may be true, but they are not yet stable enough to guide action.

ProgramSelf begins with a different question:

What invariant is this anxiety trying to protect?

## 10.4 Path Receipt copy draft

A Path Receipt is a small semantic artifact that helps you state what you are trying to preserve, what kind of help you consent to receive, what path is being made easier, why the intervention is grounded, and how the path should update when reality answers back.

## 10.5 Local AI copy draft

A good assistant should not have to guess your soul from behavioral exhaust.

Path Receipts give local AI cleaner context: declared invariants, active attractors, consent boundaries, forbidden shortcuts, feedback signals, and update rules.

The assistant no longer needs to manipulate.

It can serve the declared path.

## 10.6 Project lineage copy draft

ProgramSelf is a project of ULiUA and Consentful Cybernetics.

ULiUA holds the cultural attractor:  
Unconditional Love Includes Unconditional Acceptance.

Consentful Cybernetics holds the systems frame:  
optimization must be bounded by consent, feedback integrity, and invariant preservation.

ProgramSelf brings those principles to the personal interface.

# 11. Create Page Architecture

## 11.1 Purpose

The create page helps a person generate a Path Receipt without creating an account or storing anything.

## 11.2 Main sections

1. Future-noise
2. Invariant
3. Attractor
4. Consent
5. Non-consent
6. Intervention
7. Grounding
8. Feedback
9. Update
10. Visibility
11. Preview/export

## 11.3 Create page interaction

Each field should include:

- a short explanation,
- one prompt,
- optional examples,
- a textarea or list builder,
- live preview update.

## 11.4 Export options

Copy Markdown  
Download .path.md  
Copy JSON  
Download .path.json

No save button.

No submit button.

No account.

The browser is a temporary tool. The artifact belongs to the participant.

---

## 12. Example Pages

### 12.1 Initial example receipts

Recommended starter examples:

1. Creative sovereignty without burnout
2. Vegetables without shame
3. Relationship repair without self-abandonment
4. Local contribution without burnout
5. Sleep protection without productivity panic
6. Money clarity without scarcity spiral
7. Attention integrity without self-punishment
8. Local AI assistance without surveillance

### 12.2 Example purpose

Examples help people understand the pattern quickly.

They should not be framed as templates to obey.

They are starting points to fork.

---

## 13. Congruence Rules

### 13.1 ProgramSelf must not become what it resists

It must not use dark patterns to teach consent.

It must not create dependency while teaching sovereignty.

It must not harvest behavioral exhaust while teaching semantic permission.

It must not shame people while teaching self-orientation.

It must not become a closed platform while teaching portability.



## 13.2 Assistance must remain authorized

Any future AI feature must follow:

AI proposes.  
Human disposes.  
Receipt records.  
Feedback updates.  
Consent bounds.

## 13.3 Avoid hidden objective functions

If ProgramSelf ever recommends something, it must show:

- what invariant it serves,
- what consent authorized it,
- what grounding supports it,
- how to correct it,
- how to stop it.

## 13.4 Preserve participant sovereignty

The participant owns the receipt.

The participant chooses visibility.

The participant can revise, archive, share, fork, or discard.

The participant is not a profile.

The participant is not a target.

---

# 14. Open Questions for Review

## 14.1 Naming

Current preferred terms:

ProgramSelf  
Path Receipt  
Path Receipt Format v0.1

```
.path.md  
Invariant Set
```

Open alternatives:

```
Self-Consent Packet  
Consent Gradient Card  
Invariant-Grounded Receipt  
Consentful Path Receipt  
ProgramSelf Receipt
```

## 14.2 How esoteric should the public language be?

Current direction:

- Do not over-soften.
- The audience is already awake enough to perceive attractors versus artifacts.
- Still keep the page usable and legible.
- Avoid jargon walls.
- Let deeper terms appear through context.

## 14.3 Should glyphs be visible in v0.1?

Possible answer:

- Yes, but lightly.
- Use them as marginal markers or secondary labels.
- Do not make glyph literacy required.

## 14.4 Should AI assistance appear in v0.1?

Possible answer:

- No direct API required.
- Include prompt templates for use with any assistant.
- Add API/local assistant features only later.

## 14.5 Should ProgramSelf be explicitly “local-first”?

Possible answer:

- Yes.
- Emphasize portable files, no accounts, no cloud requirement.
- Local-first is an architectural invariant.

---

## 15. v0.1 Build Summary

ProgramSelf v0.1 should be:

```
Astro + Tailwind static site
No app
No accounts
No database
No storage
No server required
Pure client-side receipt generator
Markdown + JSON export
Portable .path.md artifacts
Public format specification
Example receipt library
Initial invariant set page
Local AI explanation page
Project lineage page
```

### 15.1 Primary deliverable

The primary deliverable is not software.

The primary deliverable is:

a portable semantic artifact that casts future-noise into invariant, attractor, consent, intervention, feedback, and update.

### 15.2 Core architectural sentence

**ProgramSelf is not an app. It is a portable format for invariant-grounded self-orientation. The website exists only to explain, generate, validate, and share Path Receipts.**

### 15.3 Core aesthetic sentence

**ProgramSelf uses warm technical minimalism: readable typography, paper-like surfaces, quiet borders, monospace semantic labels, and sparse diagrams. It should feel like a portable field manual for ego stewardship and local AI context, not a productivity app or AI startup.**

## 15.4 Core philosophical sentence

The receipt is an artifact. The path is not. The artifact helps the ego steward the attractor without collapsing it into control.

---

## 16. Closing Compression

ProgramSelf begins with one small act:

A person names the future-noise.

They ask what invariant it is trying to protect.

They identify the attractor.

They define what assistance is welcome.

They mark what would betray the path.

They choose one small intervention.

They ground it.

They let reality answer.

They update without shame.

That is the Path Receipt.

That is the seed.

Make the path easier.

Show your work.

Preserve the attractor.